

Sahana Vijay

(408) 462-2544 | sahana9vijay@gmail.com | San Jose, CA | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

Education

University of California Santa Cruz

June 2026

B.S. in Cognitive Science (Specialization in AI & HCI) | Minor in Computer Science | GPA: 3.88

Relevant Coursework: UI/UX Design, Human-Centered AI, Research Methods in Psychology, Psychological Data Analysis, Visual & Spatial Cognition, Statistics, Python Abstractions, Human Learning & Memory.

Skills

- **Usability & User Research:** Usability Testing, User Interviews, Mixed-Methods Survey Design, Information Architecture, Experimental Design, Wireframing & Prototyping, Competitor Analysis, Participant Recruitment.
- **Data Analysis & AI:** AI Prompt Engineering, LLM-Assisted Data Synthesis, Statistical Testing (Regression, T-Tests), Excel, SPSS, Python, SQL.
- **Design & Collaboration Tools:** Figma, Qualtrics, Amplitude, Looker Studio, Notion, Cross-Functional Collaboration (Engineering, Product, Design).

Experiences

Phygtl, Inc.

April 2026 - Current

Market Research & UX Analyst Intern | Remote

- Conducted competitive market benchmarking across 8 peer products (e.g., Airbnb Experiences, Nextdoor) to evaluate product positioning, feature gaps, and engagement opportunities.
- Configured automated analytics workflows (via custom AI agents) and built interactive Looker Studio dashboards to track product usage, engagement metrics, and user retention patterns.
- Analyzed quantitative user interaction data to deliver strategic market analysis reports and real-time product insights to executive leadership and investors.

UCSC Computer Vision Lab

March 2025 - June 2025

Usability & Human Factors Research Assistant | Santa Cruz, CA

- Designed and executed 15 usability testing trials across 8 distinct system configurations to optimize a web-based head-pointing interface for users with upper-limb impairments.
- Measured usability effectiveness and interface accessibility by analyzing 120 performance data points (RMSE metrics) in SPSS and Excel.
- Applied cognitive load and human factors principles to refine calibration workflows, generating 13+ clear visualizations that guided iterative UI improvements.

Ohlone College

November 2023 - May 2024

Program Research Intern | Fremont, CA

- Scoped and managed end-to-end qualitative and quantitative research to diagnose completion barriers in a high-profile Tesla-funded technical certification program.
- Recruited, screened, and surveyed 60+ participants across 3 mixed-methods research cycles to pinpoint core operational and accessibility pain points.
- Documented findings in an executive-level presentation and pitched a strategic hybrid delivery model, driving a 50% increase in student enrollment.

Projects

[Slug Housing App](#) | UX Researcher & Designer

January 2026 - March 2026

- Spearheaded end-to-end UX research, information architecture, empathy mapping, and Figma prototyping for a student off-campus housing discovery platform.
- Conducted moderated think-aloud usability testing sessions (in-person and remote) to evaluate onboarding logic, navigation clarity, and visual hierarchy.
- Identified key usability friction points (such as navigation loss) and iterated wireframes into a high-fidelity interactive prototype featuring standardized bottom navigation and optimized onboarding user flows.